

ETEN MENTORSHIP & CAPABILITY ACCELERATOR

A Structured Technology Mentorship & Capability Development System for ETEN

“Learn from people who have done it. Build the capability to do it yourself.”

Strategic thesis

Mentorship is not a community feature bolted onto ETEN. It is the connective mechanism that moves a member through Community → Academy → Capability Verification → Expert Network → Opportunities, using the readiness model ETEN has already approved.

Prepared for: Expervia

Companion to: ETEN/Expervia Commercialization Engine & Monetization Playbook v1.3; ETEN Pod Leader Role & Responsibility Framework

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Table of Contents

Right-click and select Update Field if section numbers or page numbers are not refreshed automatically.

1. Document Purpose and Positioning

This framework proposes mentorship as a core ETEN pillar — not a standalone community feature. It extends, and does not replace, the V0–V5 readiness model, the Member Journey, and the Economic Flywheel already established in the ETEN/Expervia Commercialization Engine & Monetization Playbook v1.3. Every mechanism proposed here reuses existing ETEN governance (the Verification Desk, the Commercial Readiness Panel, Pod Leaders, the Academy) rather than introducing a parallel structure.

1.1 What ETEN Mentorship is, and is not

ETEN Mentorship is	ETEN Mentorship is not
A structured pathway tied to the V0–V5 readiness model	A generic “find a mentor” directory
A curated, verified mentor pool	Open to every senior member automatically
A mechanism that produces commercial-readiness evidence	A standalone feature disconnected from Academy and Verification
A contribution channel that feeds Pod leadership and the Opportunity Engine	A parallel trust or scoring system running alongside ETEN's existing model

2. Strategic Rationale

The purpose of mentorship inside ETEN is not career advice. It is to move a member along a defined progression: Interest → Learning → Practice → Capability → Verification → Commercial Readiness → Opportunity. That progression already exists as the ETEN Member Journey (Playbook Section 12); mentorship is the mechanism that makes each step happen with a real person guiding it, rather than self-serve content alone.

External benchmark

Microsoft's own MVP programme has moved toward “Mentoring Rings” — small community-led groups rather than one-to-one matching alone (Microsoft Community Hub, 2026). This is used here as a design analogy for the Mentorship Circles format below, not as evidence that Microsoft operates or endorses ETEN's programme.

Because mentorship sits inside the existing flywheel rather than requiring a new one, it should not be drawn as a separate diagram. It strengthens one specific link already named in the Playbook's Economic Flywheel: “Members gain earnings and reputation → Expervia reinvests contribution into product, demand and capability.” Mentorship is the operating mechanism for that link, and for the Playbook's Member Journey “Lead” stage (“Govern people, quality or IP”).

3. Integration with the ETEN Readiness Model

Mentorship roles map directly onto the existing V0–V5 readiness levels. This is a deliberate design choice: it avoids creating a second capability scale that would compete with the one ETEN has already approved.

Current level	Mentorship role
V0 — Registered	Orientation mentor
V1 — Credential Verified	Certification mentor

Current level	Mentorship role
V2 — Capability Verified	Technical mentor
V3 — Commercially Ready	Presales / career mentor
V4 — Proven Specialist	Leadership / industry mentor
V5 — Lead Specialist	Mentor / Pod Leader / Expert Coach

4. Mentorship Formats

Four formats are defined so the model is not limited to one-to-one relationships. Only one launches in Phase 1; the rest are sequenced against evidence, per Section 9.

Format	Structure	Primary use case	Phase
1:1 Expert Mentorship	One mentor, one mentee, goal-defined (e.g. "Azure Administrator → Solutions Architect in 6 months")	Individual technical or career goals	Phase 2
Mentorship Circles	One mentor, 5–10 mentees, weekly/biweekly, cohort-based	Pod-based technical development; easiest to run and to commercialise	Phase 1 — launch format
Project Mentorship	One mentor supervises 2–4 mentees on a real or simulated engagement	Converts practice into verified project evidence for the capability passport	Phase 2, once Circles are stable
Executive / Leadership Mentorship	Senior-to-senior, premium tier	CTO/CIO, practice-building, presales leadership	Phase 3 — paid premium tier

5. Mentor Verification and Levels

Not every senior member becomes a mentor automatically — doing so would undermine the trust model the rest of ETEN is built on. Mentor verification is a decision of the existing Verification Desk and Commercial Readiness Panel (Playbook Task 2.3), extended to cover a mentor-specific evidence set. No new governance body is created.

5.1 Minimum mentor evidence

- Professional experience, certifications and technology specialisation
- Project and industry history
- Existing ETEN capability level (V-status)
- Availability, geographic coverage and language
- At least one verifiable reference

5.2 Mentor levels

Level	Minimum criteria
Mentor Candidate	Nominated by a Pod Leader; meets minimum evidence above
Verified Mentor	Evidence confirmed by the Verification Desk; approved for one Circle

Level	Minimum criteria
Senior Mentor	One completed cohort with documented mentee progression
Expert Mentor	Multiple cohorts; consistent mentee outcomes; V4+ status
ETEN Master Mentor	Sustained outcomes plus leadership evidence; eligible for Pod Leader consideration

6. Value Exchange for Mentors

If mentors are asked to give significant time for free indefinitely, the programme will not hold. Financial mechanisms are introduced deliberately and in sequence, using the existing revenue waterfall and contributor-payment logic already defined in the Playbook (“Who gets paid, for what, and when”) rather than a new payment system.

Phase	Non-financial value	Financial value
Phase 1	Mentor badge, Expert Score credit, Pod-leadership consideration, visibility	None — recognition only, to keep initial load bounded and voluntary
Phase 2+	All of the above, plus featured profile and speaking opportunities	Paid Circle facilitation fee once the first commercial cohort (Section 10) launches
Phase 3+	Leadership pathway, access to enterprise opportunities	Paid 1:1 sessions, project supervision fees, executive mentorship retainer

7. Where Mentorship Sits in the Existing System

Rather than redrawing ETEN's flywheel or member journey, mentorship is inserted at four specific, existing points:

Existing mechanism	Playbook reference	Mentorship addition
Member Journey	Section 12	Mentor-reviewed evidence is recognised as valid proof at the Specialise, Prove, Contribute and Lead stages
Economic Flywheel	Section G	Mentors are the named pathway from “members gain earnings/reputation” to “Expervia reinvests contribution into capability”
Readiness Panel	Task 2.3	The same panel absorbs mentor-verification decisions; no new governance body
Pod Leader Framework	Core Responsibility “Develop Future Pod Leaders”	Mentorship becomes the operating mechanism for that already-approved responsibility

8. Phase 1 — What We Build First

Modelled on the same discipline as the Playbook's own four-week platform MVP (Section 11.1): the smallest version that produces real evidence and real commercial signal, with everything else deliberately deferred.

- Every V2+ member can be nominated by their Pod Leader as a Mentor Candidate; verification reuses credential and practical-assessment evidence already on file — no new verification workflow.

- One format only: Mentorship Circles, run inside existing Pods and timed to the existing 14-day commercial-readiness sprint or Academy cohort calendar.
- Matching is manual: Pod Leaders assemble circles from their own roster. No automated matching engine.
- A mentee's goal is a single structured field — the V-level and capability being worked toward — not a free-form goal-builder.
- Mentorship participation (attendance, assignment completion, mentor sign-off) is logged as evidence in the existing capability passport / Portfolio-Proof Builder, not a new module.
- Mentors receive recognition only (badge, Expert Score credit, Pod-leadership consideration) — no payment mechanism yet.
- One pilot Circle launches per initial capability cell — Modern Work, Data & AI, Business Applications — alongside the first commercial-readiness sprint.

9. What We Are Deferring, and Why

Every deferred item has a named unlock condition, using the same evidence-gated logic as the Playbook's Scaling Decision Gates — so a later request to build one of these is evaluated against evidence, not momentum.

Deferred item	Why not now	Unlock condition
1:1 concierge mentorship	Needs a working matching and scheduling flow the MVP doesn't have	Circles format proven across 2 consecutive cohorts
Project Mentorship	Needs supervised delivery/QA capacity already stretched by commercial sprints	Delivery governance capacity confirmed available
Executive / Leadership tier	Premium positioning needs proven Circle outcomes first	2+ referenceable Circle cohorts with documented V3+ conversion
Mentor Marketplace (search, filter, self-serve request)	A directory before density is the exact "marketplace launched too early" risk already named in the Playbook's Risk Register	Sufficient mentor density and demand across 3+ capability cells
Mentor Score algorithm	Premature scoring erodes trust before enough outcome data exists	At least one full cohort cycle of outcome data per mentor
Reverse mentorship	Adds a second workflow before the first is proven	Core mentorship stable and at Stage 2+ of the sprint scaling ladder
Corporate / university / sponsored programmes	Needs one proven, referenceable internal cohort first	First Circle cohort graduates with documented outcomes
Mentorship + Certification accelerator product	Needs Academy content and Circle format both proven independently	Both proven; product bundles them deliberately

10. Commercialisation Phasing

Mentorship's primary near-term value is not a new product — it is the talent-development layer that feeds Expervia's commercial delivery engine (the Playbook's mentorship-to-squad pipeline logic), which is already active and free from Phase 1. Paid products are introduced only in the sequence already defined by the Playbook's Revenue-Mix Evolution table, not as a parallel roadmap.

Horizon	Mentorship commercial activity	Status
0–6 months	Mentorship Circles bundled inside existing paid/sponsored Academy cohorts; mentor contribution unpaid but logged as evidence	No new product — extends existing revenue lines
6–18 months	First standalone paid product: a 12-Week Technology Career & Capability Accelerator (Circle + Academy + evidence, one capability cell only); first single-client corporate pilot	New Academy-layer product; one pilot, not a programme
18–36 months	Corporate, university and sponsored programmes expand; Executive tier; Project Mentorship	Matches the ETEN Pro / enterprise-workspace horizon already defined in the Playbook
36+ months	Mentor Marketplace, Mentor Score, Reverse Mentorship	Matches the Playbook's platform-maturity horizon

10.1 Indicative pricing — Phase 1–2 products only

Executive and enterprise pricing is intentionally not scoped here; it belongs to Phase 3, once a pilot has produced real willingness-to-pay data.

Product	Format	Indicative range (NGN)	Status
Mentorship Circle (standalone)	6–8 week group cohort	₦50,000 – ₦150,000 per mentee	Test in Phase 2 pilot
12-Week Career & Capability Accelerator	Circle + Academy + evidence	₦300,000 – ₦750,000	Phase 2 flagship product

These are commercial design ranges, not market-validated prices — consistent with how the Playbook treats its own illustrative figures elsewhere. Willingness-to-pay should be tested with the first pilot cohort before pricing is locked.

11. Governance, Risk and Ownership

11.1 Ownership (reuses existing roles)

Activity	Owner
Nominate mentor candidates	Pod Leaders
Approve mentor verification level	Commercial Readiness Panel / Verification Desk
Design Circle curriculum and assignments	Academy Lead
Operate Circle cohorts	Pod Leaders + Academy
Log mentorship evidence to the capability passport	Product / Platform Owner
Approve Phase 2 productisation and pricing pilot	Commercialisation Lead / Expervia CEO

11.2 Risk register additions

These extend, rather than replace, the Playbook's existing Risk Register.

Risk	Early signal	Mitigation	Owner
Mentor burnout / unpaid-load fatigue	Declining mentor availability or Circle no-shows	Cap mentor load to one Circle at a time in Phase 1; introduce recognition before scaling volume	ETEN Lead
Mentor-quality erosion	Mentee complaints, low assignment completion, no V-level progression	Verification stays inside the existing Readiness Panel; no self-nomination without Pod Leader sign-off	Commercial Readiness Panel
Mentorship-platform overbuilding	Feature requests for marketplace or matching engine before the first cohort completes	Hold to the Phase 1 scope (Section 8) until the Section 9 unlock conditions are met	Product / CEO

12. Management Decisions Required Now

- Approve mentorship as a core ETEN pillar, structurally tied to the V0-V5 readiness model — not a standalone community feature.
- Approve Mentorship Circles as the sole Phase 1 format, launched inside the existing Pod structure and commercial-readiness sprint calendar.
- Approve mentor verification as an extension of the existing Verification Desk / Commercial Readiness Panel — no new governance body.
- Approve non-financial recognition only for Phase 1 mentors; defer payment mechanisms to the first Phase 2 pilot.
- Approve one pilot Circle per initial capability cell (Modern Work, Data & AI, Business Applications), timed to the next commercial-readiness sprint.
- Approve the Section 9 deferral list and its unlock conditions, so future requests to add the Marketplace, Executive tier or Reverse Mentorship are evaluated against evidence rather than momentum.

13. Source Basis

Internal source: Onyii's Mentorship & Capability Development proposal, 9 September 2026, developed as a companion to the ETEN/Expervia Commercialization Engine & Monetization Playbook v1.3 (29 August 2026) and the ETEN Pod Leader Role & Responsibility Framework.

External benchmark: Microsoft Community Hub, "MVP Mentoring Rings: Where Community Becomes a Catalyst," 2026 — <https://techcommunity.microsoft.com/blog/mvp-blog/mvp-mentoring-rings-where-community-becomes-a-catalyst/4522015>

Interpretation note

The Mentoring Rings reference is used as a design analogy for the Mentorship Circles format — small, community-led groups rather than one-to-one matching alone — not as evidence that Microsoft operates, endorses or is affiliated with ETEN's programme.